

Assessment and Analysis Cell

Southern Africa Flooding – Mozambique Focus

Meeting Notes

Date: Thursday, 22 January 2026

Time: 16:00–17:00 CET

Chair: Herbert Tatham, Unit Lead – Needs Assessment, OCHA Humanitarian Programme Cycle Section (HPCS), chairing on behalf of Fawad Husain Syed (A&A Cell Emergency Focal Point – Mozambique Floods)

1. Opening and Objectives

The meeting was opened by Herbert Tatham, who welcomed participants and acknowledged the broad inter-agency attendance, including OCHA headquarters, regional and country offices, UNDAC, clusters, technical agencies, and NGO partners. The Chair clarified that he was chairing the meeting on behalf of Fawad, who serves as the Assessment and Analysis (A&A) Cell focal point for the Mozambique floods emergency but was unavailable due to a conflicting commitment.

The Chair outlined the objectives of the meeting as follows:

- (i) to provide a consolidated update on the evolving flood situation in Mozambique within the wider Southern Africa regional context;
 - (ii) to align UNDAC deployment, country-level and regional analysis, and inter-agency analytical capacities;
 - (iii) to clarify the operational status and activation level of the A&A Cell; and
 - (iv) to identify priority analytical needs, coordination arrangements, and next steps.
- Participants were informed that the meeting was being recorded and that materials would be shared subsequently.

2. UNDAC Deployment Update

Peter Muller from OCHA ERS provided the UNDAC deployment to Mozambique. Participants were informed that an UNDAC team of 15 personnel is deploying to support the Government of Mozambique and the humanitarian community. The larger team will be based in Gaza and small support team Maputo. The deployment includes expertise in coordination, assessment and analysis, information management (IM), and logistics.

It was confirmed in the meeting chat that Sergio da Silva will serve as the UNDAC Team Leader. The UNDAC deployment is coordinated with the National Institute for Disaster Risk Management and Reduction (INGD) and will operate in support of national and provincial emergency coordination structures.

The Southern African Development Community (SADC) Emergency Response Team is co-deploying alongside UNDAC, providing additional regional surge capacity. Furthermore, INSARAG-classified international search and rescue teams have been activated, and amphibious and aerial assets are being mobilized to address severe access constraints caused by widespread flooding.

3. OCHA Country Office Situation Update – Mozambique

Federica D'Andreagiovanni from the OCHA Mozambique Country Office presented a detailed situation update, noting that severe flooding continues to affect large parts of central and southern Mozambique, primarily Gaza, Maputo, and Sofala provinces, with impacts also reported in Niassa, Zambezia, and Tete. The flooding is driven by sustained heavy rainfall, compounded by upstream river inflows, with multiple river basins remaining above alert levels.

As of 20 January 2026, approximately 600,000 people are estimated to be affected nationwide, with figures expected to increase as assessments continue. Approximately 392,000 people have been displaced, predominantly due to inundation of residential areas. Infrastructure damage is extensive, with more than 70,000 houses reported as destroyed or flooded. At least 18 health facilities have sustained damage, and approximately 5,000 kilometres of roads have been affected, including key sections of the N1 national highway, significantly disrupting access and supply chains.

Livelihood impacts are severe, with an estimated 105,000 hectares of agricultural land affected and approximately 34,000 head of livestock lost, undermining food security and income sources. Large-scale evacuations are ongoing, with around 66,000 people currently accommodated in 66 accommodation centres, the majority located in Gaza Province (approximately 50,000 people).

The Country Office emphasized heightened public health and protection risks, including increased exposure to cholera and malaria, driven by displacement, overcrowding in accommodation centres, damage to WASH infrastructure, and disruption of health services. Access constraints were identified as the primary operational challenge, with flooded road networks, flash flooding, fuel shortages, and disrupted supply chains significantly limiting humanitarian reach to affected and isolated communities.

4. Regional Situation Update – Southern Africa

The OCHA Regional Office for Southern and Eastern Africa (ROSEA) provided a regional overview, situating the Mozambique floods within a broader pattern of flooding across Southern Africa, including impacts and heightened risks in Eswatini, Malawi, Zimbabwe, Zambia, and South Africa. Updated rainfall forecasts indicate continued precipitation and potential flood risk across several river basins in the coming days.

The regional update highlighted the importance of cross-border hydrological dynamics, including dam management and upstream river discharges, particularly those affecting downstream areas in Mozambique. Continued coordination with SADC structures, including the SADC Humanitarian Operations Centre (SHOC), was emphasized to ensure regional situational awareness and coordinated response planning.

5. Partner Updates

A wide range of partners provided substantive updates on analytical, mapping, modelling, and operational support, both verbally and through the meeting chat.

ECHO and Copernicus reported the activation of the **Copernicus Emergency Mapping Service (EMSR857)** for Mozambique. Flood extent maps, damage assessments, and situation analyses are being produced and updated. ECHO highlighted close collaboration with **UNOSAT**, including the use of satellite-based analysis to support situational awareness.

The **European Commission's Joint Research Centre (JRC)**, represented by **Chiara Proietti**, reported that it is closely monitoring the evolution of flooding across Mozambique and the wider Southern Africa region, with a particular focus on updated **rainfall forecasts**. JRC noted a projected **increase in cumulative rainfall over a four-day period**, which could further aggravate flooding conditions, although these forecasts are not expected to directly affect **Gaza Province**, which is already severely impacted. In coordination with **ECHO**, JRC highlighted serious concerns regarding **ongoing dam discharges in Eswatini** and the **critical status of several sand dams**, and confirmed that **dam-break and downstream impact scenarios** have been developed using realistic data on reservoir water levels and discharge patterns. JRC indicated that these analyses are available to support preparedness and response planning and can be shared or refined upon request through the A&A Cell.

UNOSAT shared links to the **Sentinel-1 FloodAI Monitoring Dashboard** and the **Satellite Mapping and Crisis Support (SMCS)** platform, providing near real-time satellite-detected surface water analysis. Joint work between ECHO and UNOSAT has also included **dam-break scenario modelling**, using realistic reservoir and discharge data, particularly in relation to **Eswatini dams** and potential downstream impacts in Mozambique.

DRRS (Deltares) confirmed that **near real-time flood modelling** has been conducted for Mozambique and the wider Southern Africa region. This modelling includes **forecast scenarios and estimated affected populations**, which have been shared with OCHA since the previous week. DRRS remains on standby to provide **follow-up analyses or higher-resolution modelling** focused on specific provinces or river basins upon request.

MapAction confirmed that it has already initiated production of **overview and administrative maps**, as well as **thematic maps** covering critical infrastructure, including **health facilities, schools, airstrips, and road access constraints**. Additional products are in the pipeline, and coordination with OCHA and UNDAC on priority mapping needs is ongoing.

ACAPS reported that it is on standby to provide remote analytical support. A **rapid multi-sector briefing note** is in production, covering flooding impacts in **Gaza, Maputo, Niassa, Sofala, and Zambezia provinces**, with publication planned for **Sunday**. ACAPS requested the latest validated data on displacement figures, response activities, and mapping outputs to ensure accuracy prior to publication.

iMMAP Inc. confirmed the deployment of **Iga Denis** and **Marko Espico** as part of the first UNDAC rotation, providing in-country IM and analysis capacity. iMMAP also confirmed the availability of **remote support** for information management, GIS, data management, and analysis to support a potential **remote A&A Cell**. Coordination is ongoing with **Antonio Beleza** at **SADC SHOC**, and longer-term IM and analysis support via the **Standby Partnership (SBP)** mechanism could be considered if required.

Data Friendly Space (DFS) reported that it has conducted internal analytical work on Mozambique since the previous week, although no products have yet been made public. DFS confirmed availability to contribute to **ad-hoc analytical requests** or to produce **joint institutional A&A Cell products**, pending clarification of priority needs and tasking.

From the **Health Cluster (WHO)**, it was reported that **health situation reports** are being produced on an ongoing basis. **Health partner mapping** is being updated, and tracking of **affected health facilities** continues in coordination with national authorities. Relevant datasets and dashboards were shared via the chat.

The **Logistics Cluster** confirmed the deployment of **two staff members** within the UNDAC team, with an estimated arrival in **Maputo** the following day. The cluster will assess **logistics gaps and constraints**, including access, storage, and transport, and will advise on the potential need for cluster activation.

Additional coordination tools and resources were shared via the meeting chat, including:

- The [Mozambique Assessments Registry](#) (Google Sheet);
- [HDX Mozambique sub-national administrative boundary datasets](#);
- Kobo references for data collection;
- Links to [Copernicus](#), [UNOSAT](#), and [FloodAI dashboards](#).

6. A&A Cell Activation and Way Forward

In concluding the substantive discussion, the Chair noted that the deployment of UNDAC with embedded assessment and analysis capacity effectively places the response at an **active A&A Cell activation level**, thereby triggering **remote A&A Cell support**.

The immediate priority is to **calibrate analytical, IM, and mapping support** to clearly articulated needs from the **OCHA Mozambique Country Office** and **ROSEA**. OCHA will facilitate alignment between UNDAC, the Country Office, the Regional Office, and **SADC** to develop a **prioritized menu of analytical and IM services**, ensuring complementarity and avoiding duplication.

Participants were advised that **discrete analytical taskings** should begin to be conceptualized immediately, with further coordination and follow-up meetings to be convened as required over the coming days. The Chair reiterated that the A&A Cell activation framework remains under pilot testing and that lessons learned from the Mozambique floods response will inform future refinements, including potential **tiered activation approaches**.

7. Closing

The Chair thanked all participants for their strong engagement, technical contributions, and willingness to support the response. Participants were informed that the **meeting recording and presentation materials** would be shared. It was noted that further communication and tasking would follow as analytical priorities are refined in consultation with the Country Office and Regional Office.